

Few Windows users are aware of the swap file (or virtual memory) settings. The swap file is a reserved portion on the drive (the default is the C: drive) that serves as virtual RAM, and it is used if there's no RAM left for running a particular program (refer §1.4.1). You can tweak the virtual memory settings to make your system work a little faster (Refer Chapter 8 for more details on this). This virtual memory can be seen on its target drive as a hidden file called 'Pagefile.sys'.

The 'My Documents' folder has sub-folders by default: 'My Pictures', 'My Music' and 'My Received Files'. Images and music are usually stored in the first two folders respectively, while 'My Received Files' is used by MSN messenger to store files that are transferred to you by your friends via the Internet.

Assuming that your computer is connected to a LAN through which you are connected to the Internet, 'My Network Places' shows up folders shared by other computers on your network or domain. The shared folders are visible if and only if your Internet Service Provider (ISP) does not implement a Firewall to prevent its users from interacting.

4.2.2 Folder Views

The manner in which files and sub-folders are arranged under a parent folder depends on the Folder View options. The default viewing option is 'Icons'; there are five other options—Filmstrip, Thumbnails, Tiles, List and Details.

'Filmstrip' is applicable only for image viewing; it displays images as a strip of film with a larger preview above the strip. 'Thumbnails' shows a preview of the contents of a folder. 'Icons' and 'Tiles' are arrangement of files and folder into rows and columns. The display and font size for the 'Tiles' view is slightly larger than in the 'Icons' view. 'List' and 'Details' both display the content of a folder one below the other; the text and icon size under this view are the smallest. 'Details', as the name suggests, shows more information about a file such as the size, date/time of creation and modification, and more.